1/5/25

Ch- Power Sharing

NCERT Book Question Answers

Q1 What are the different forms of power sharing in modern democracies? Give an example of each of these.

Ans Power shared among different organs of the government:

* In it power is shared among legislature, executive and judiciary.
* It is also called horizontal distribution of power because all these organs are placed at the same level.
* Such a seperation ensures that none of the organs can exercise unlimited powers.

B. Power shared among Governments at different levels:

* There is a government for the entire country, such a Government is called federal Government.
* In India we refer to it as Central or Union government.
* The Government at provincial or regional level is called State Government in India.

Power Shared among different social groups:

* This type of arrangement is made to give space in the Government and administration to diverse social groups who otherwise feel alienated from the Government.
* When there is competition, it ensures that power does not remain in one hand.
* This method is used to give minority communities a fair share in power.

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Power shared among political parties, pressure groups:

- In a democracy, the citizen must have freedom to choose among various contenders for power.
- In the long run, power is shared among different political parties that represent different ideologies and social groups. This type of Government is called 'Coalition Government'.
- Many interest groups like traders, business men, farmers, industrial workers, also have a share in governmental power either way, through participation and influencing decision making process.

Q2 State one prudential reason and one moral reason for power sharing with an example from the Indian context.

Ans Tyranny of the majority undermines the unity of the nation therefore power sharing helps to reduce the possibility of conflict between social groups and ensures stability of the political order. This is a prudential reason for power sharing. In India, seats in panchayat elections are reserved for those from marginalised communities to ensure they have a stake in the political order.

Those who are affected by the exercise of power have the right to be consulted and acquire a stake by sharing that power. This is the moral reason for power sharing. In India, the policy of reservation in government recruitement ensures marginalised communities are given means to become part of the structure of government.

Q3 After reading this chapter, three students drew different conclusions. Which of these do you agree with and why? Give your reasons in about 50 words.

Ans I agree with Joseph's statement that every society needs some form of power sharing even if it is small or does not have social divisions. Even if small, power sharing allows a sense of equality and belonging within the larger society. Power sharing also ensures that small social groups are accommodated and divisions in society do not emanate in the future.

Q4 The Mayor of Merchtem, a town near Brussels in Belgium, has defended a ban on speaking French in the town's schools. He said that the ban would help all non-Dutch speakers integrate in this flemish town. Do you think this measure is in keeping with the spirit of the Belgium's power sharing arrangements? Give your reasons in about 50 words.

Ans No, the measure is not in the spirit of Belgium's power sharing arrangements. Belgium ensures that both French-speaking and Dutch speaking communities are accommodated equally. The measure leads to the tyranny of the Dutch majority and would lead to marginalization of French-speakers.

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This would lead to their division from society rather than ~~in~~ intergration.

Q5 Read the passage and pick out any of the prudentional reasons for power sharing offered.

Ans Prudential reasoning means to be based on careful calculation of gains and losses. The prudential reason for Panchayti Raj is that it restores power directly to the people, allows greater control over developement schemes and would increase administrative efficiency. It would also reduce corruption and eliminate the corrupt middlemen.

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Worksheet

Answer the following short Questions

1-Ans Sri Lankan Tamils put forward several demands to address their grievances. Three key demands were:

a Recognition of Tamil as an official language alongside Sinhala.

b Regional autonomy in areas with a significant Tamil population.

c Equal opportunities in education and employment.

2-Ans Sharing power ensures inclusive governance, allowing diverse groups to participate in decision-making. This fosters trust, reduces conflicts, and strengthens national unity. When different communities feel represented, stability increases, making a country more powerful and cohesive. Balanced power distribution creates harmony, leading to a stronger, united nation.

3-Ans In modern democracies, power is shared among the legislative, executive, and judiciary to prevent misuse. This separation of powers ensures checks and balances, promoting fair governance. Each organ has distinct role - law-making, implementation, and interpretation - maintaining accountability and protecting citizen's rights, leading to a stable and effective democracy.

4-Ans Belgium embraced power-sharing, ensuring equal representation for Dutch and French speakers, fostering unity. Sri Lanka, however, followed majoritarianism, favoring the Sinhalese, which led to ethnic tensions. Belgium's approach promoted harmony, while Sri Lanka's policies alienated Tamils, fueling conflict. Their contrasting methods shaped their respective social stability.

5-Ans Majoritarianism is a system where the majority community dominates governance, often sidelining minorities. In Sri Lanka, the Sinhalese majority favoured policies like declaring Sinhala the only official language and Buddhism the state religion, alienating Tamils. This led to ethnic tensions and demands for equality and autonomy.

Answer the following in Long Answers

1-Ans Federal power sharing divides authority between different levels of government - national and regional - to ensure efficient governance and representation of diverse groups. Each level has specific responsibilities, preventing concentration of power.

Vertical distribution of power refers to the division of power across multiple tiers - central, state, and local governments. Higher levels handle broader national matters, while lower levels manage local issues. This system promotes decentralization, allowing different

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regions to address their unique needs effectively, ensuring a balanced and inclusive democracy.

2-Ans Power is shared among political parties through elections, coalition governments, and opposition representation, ensuring diverse voices shape policies. Pressure groups - like trade unions and civil rights organization - also influence decisions - making by advocating for public interests.
This system ensures democratic balance, preventing dominance by a single entity. It fosters pluralism, representing varied societal views and interests. By distributing power, it enhances accountability, responsiveness, and stability in governance, making policies more reflective of public needs. This dynamic interaction between parties and pressure groups.

3-Ans Belgium's power-sharing model ensures equal representation among Dutch and French-speaking communities. It includes:

a Equal government representation - Both linguistic groups have equal ministers in central government.
b Autonomous regional governments - Regions govern their own affairs, reducing conflicts.
c Community-based governance - Each language community manages its cultural and educational matters.
d Special laws requiring majority approval - Decisions affecting both groups need consent from both sides.

This system promotes political stability by protecting minority rights and fostering unity, preventing ethnic tensions like those seen in Sri Lanka. It's unique approach to managing diversity.

Authority

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